

Database Failover Runbook

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WARNING: Never been tested in production. Treat as a guide only.

When to Use

If the primary RDS instance is unreachable or returning errors for > 5 minutes.

Steps

1. Confirm primary is down: check RDS console / CloudWatch
2. Trigger manual failover in RDS console (Multi-AZ failover)
OR run: `aws rds failover-db-cluster --db-cluster-identifier acme-prod`
3. Monitor DNS propagation (can take 60-120s)
4. Verify application reconnects - check app logs
5. Notify team in #incidents

Expected Downtime

60-120 seconds for automatic failover.

Post-Failover

- + Raise incident report
- + Review RDS events for root cause
- + Consider promoting read replica if failover doesn't work

